

MARKET ENTRY RESOURCE

The Bangkok Brand Entry Checklist

Everything you need before entering the Thailand market — from validation to 90-day growth.

5 PHASES · 29 ACTION ITEMS

PHASE 01

Market Validation

Validate your concept before committing budget. These 7 checks take 1–2 weeks and save months of costly mistakes.

- ☐ **Define your target segment:** expat, tourist, local Thai, or mixed
- ☐ **Research 3 direct competitors** already operating in Bangkok
- ☐ **Confirm your price point** works in the Thai market — check local benchmarks
- ☐ **Identify your top 2 delivery platforms:** GrabFood, Foodpanda, LINE MAN
- ☐ **Understand Thai FDA requirements** for your product category
- ☐ **Test your product name and brand** for cultural fit in Thai context
- ☐ **Define your Month 1 success metric** — orders, revenue, or reviews

PHASE 02

Setup Checklist

Before launch day, these 6 operational decisions need to be locked. Rushing them post-launch costs 2–3× more.

- ☐ **Decide on legal structure:** operate under local partner vs register Thai company
- ☐ **Confirm your production base:** cloud kitchen, commissary, or own facility
- ☐ **Identify your local commercial contact** — sales, ops, and marketing
- ☐ **Set up business LINE and WhatsApp** — primary customer channels in Thailand
- ☐ **Brief your packaging** for Thai-language labelling requirements
- ☐ **Budget for 90-day runway** including ops, marketing and product testing

PHASE 03

Launch Week

Your first 7 days set the trajectory. Nail these 6 actions to build momentum from Day 1.

- ☐ **Activate delivery platform accounts** — GrabFood store setup takes 3–5 days
- ☐ **Photograph your product** for Thai delivery app thumbnails — bright, close-up shots convert best
- ☐ **Set opening promotion:** 20–30% discount in first 2 weeks drives initial reviews
- ☐ **Set up review management:** respond to every GrabFood and Foodpanda review
- ☐ **Brief your local team** on daily reporting: orders, complaints, feedback
- ☐ **Share your first week data** with all stakeholders — establish the reporting cadence

PHASE 04

90-Day Growth

The first 90 days determine whether you stay, scale, or pivot. Follow this cadence to make data-driven decisions.

- ☐ **Week 4:** Review data and decide product adjustments for Thai palate
- ☐ **Week 6:** Activate first B2B outreach — offices, co-working spaces, corporate lunch
- ☐ **Week 8:** Review channel mix — delivery vs dine-in vs HORECA
- ☐ **Week 10:** Plan first marketing push based on best-performing SKUs
- ☐ **Week 12:** Decision point — scale, pivot, or expand to second location

Ready to enter Bangkok with a local partner?



Want a local partner to execute this checklist with you? We've helped international food and retail brands launch in Thailand — from legal setup to delivery platform optimisation.

Book a call at ncglobalassets.com